

Neo- and Post-Impressionism

Post-Impressionism was a phase of creative experimentation from around 1880 to 1910, when some artists reacted against Impressionism's preoccupation with straightforward, superficial appearances. They included Paul Gauguin, Van Gogh, Toulouse-Lautrec, Cézanne and Georges Seurat. With no single style, Post-Impressionists expressed themselves in unnatural hues and distorted forms. Van Gogh and Gauguin used brilliant colours and shapes to convey their feelings, Cézanne used hatched brushmarks to depict structure, and Toulouse-Lautrec portrayed Parisian life in colourful, sinuous images.

The term 'Neo-Impressionism' was coined in 1886 by art critic Félix Fénéon (1861–1944) to describe the work of Seurat, Paul Signac and followers. Inspired by the colour theories of chemist Michel Eugène Chevreul (1786–1889) and others, they painted pictures in dots of pure colour, rather than mixing on their palettes. Seurat called it Divisionism, but it became better known as Pointillism.



Van Gogh, *Vase with 12 Sunflowers*, 1888